Defence & International Relations — Master File · SSC CGL

> **The single consolidated Defence & IR resource** — armed forces & ranks, DRDO & missiles, military exercises, UN & world organizations, India's groupings & boundary lines, with PYQ question-types, curated & new questions. Per the PYQ Blueprint.

> ⚠ Current summits/FTAs/appointments change fast — verify before the exam. Static facts (ranks, missile names, boundary lines, HQs) are stable.

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1. How SSC Asks Defence/IR (PYQ Types)

Type	Example stem	Prep
Rank match	"Highest rank in the Indian Army —"	Ranks (§2)
Missile → type	"Agni-V is a —"	Missiles (§3)
Exercise → countries	"Malabar exercise is between —"	Exercises (§4)
Org → HQ / members	"HQ of NATO is —"	World bodies (§5)
Grouping	"BRICS members are —"	Groupings (§6)
Boundary line	"38th Parallel divides —"	Lines (§7)

2. Indian Armed Forces & Ranks

- **Supreme Commander** of the armed forces: the **President of India**.
- **Chief of Defence Staff (CDS)** — heads the Dept of Military Affairs; first CDS: **Gen. Bipin Rawat (2020)**.
- Three services: **Army, Navy, Air Force**.

Army	Navy	Air Force
Field Marshal (highest, honorary)	**Admiral of the Fleet**	**Marshal of the IAF**
General (serving head)	Admiral	Air Chief Marshal
Lt. General	Vice Admiral	Air Marshal
Major General	Rear Admiral	Air Vice Marshal

- **Field Marshals of India:** Sam Manekshaw & K. M. Cariappa (only two).
- **Training academies:** NDA (Khadakwasla, Pune), IMA (Dehradun), OTA (Chennai), Indian Naval Academy (Ezhimala), Air Force Academy (Dundigal).
- **Gallantry awards:** Param Vir Chakra (wartime, highest) · Ashoka Chakra (peacetime, highest).

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3. DRDO, Missiles & Defence Systems

- **DRDO** — Defence Research & Development Organisation (HQ New Delhi); "father of Indian missile programme": **A. P. J. Abdul Kalam**.

Missile	Type
Agni series	Surface-to-surface ballistic (Agni-V ≈ intercontinental range)
Prithvi	Surface-to-surface (short range)
Akash	Surface-to-air
Nag	Anti-tank
BrahMos	Supersonic cruise (India–Russia joint)
Astra	Air-to-air
Trishul	Short-range surface-to-air

- **Aircraft/systems:** Tejas (LCA, indigenous fighter), INS Vikrant (indigenous aircraft carrier), Arjun (main battle tank), S-400 (air defence, from Russia).

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4. Military Exercises

Exercise	Between
Malabar	India, USA, Japan, Australia (naval)
Yudh Abhyas	India–USA (army)
Indra	India–Russia
Varuna	India–France (naval)
Garuda	India–France (air)
Hand-in-Hand	India–China
Mitra Shakti	India–Sri Lanka
Surya Kiran	India–Nepal
Nomadic Elephant	India–Mongolia
Desert Knight	India–France (air)

5. United Nations & World Bodies

- **UN** founded **24 Oct 1945** (UN Day); HQ **New York**; 193 members; official languages 6.
- **6 principal organs:** General Assembly, **Security Council** (5 permanent — USA, UK, France, Russia, China — + 10 non-permanent), ECOSOC, Secretariat, ICJ (The Hague), Trusteeship Council (suspended).
- **Secretary-General:** António Guterres (verify current).
- **HQs:** WHO/WTO/ILO — Geneva · IMF/World Bank — Washington · UNESCO — Paris · **NATO — Brussels** · ICJ — The Hague · IAEA/OPEC — Vienna.

6. India's International Groupings

Grouping	Members / note
BRICS	Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa (+ new members)
QUAD	India, USA, Japan, Australia
SCO	Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (China, Russia, India, etc.)
G20	19 countries + EU (+ African Union)
SAARC	South Asian nations (HQ Kathmandu)
ASEAN	Southeast Asia (HQ Jakarta) — India is a dialogue partner
G7	USA, UK, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, Canada
BIMSTEC	Bay of Bengal nations
I2U2	India, Israel, UAE, USA

7. Boundary Lines (world)

Line	Divides
Radcliffe Line	India–Pakistan
McMahon Line	India–China (Arunachal)
Durand Line	Afghanistan–Pakistan
38th Parallel	North–South Korea
49th Parallel	USA–Canada
Maginot Line	France–Germany
Hindenburg / Oder–Neisse Line	Germany–Poland
17th Parallel	(former) North–South Vietnam

8. Current Affairs — International (verify)

- G7 & G20 rotate hosts annually; **India hosted G20 in 2023** (New Delhi).
- India's recent FTAs/partnerships: UAE (CEPA), Australia (ECTA), New Zealand, UK — verify latest.
- UNSC non-permanent seats rotate; India seeks permanent membership (G4: India, Japan, Germany, Brazil).

9. Curated PYQ-Pattern Questions

Q1. Supreme Commander of the Indian armed forces — (a) PM (b) **President** (c) CDS (d) Defence Minister

Q2. Highest rank in the Indian Army — (a) General (b) **Field Marshal** (c) Lt. General (d) Brigadier

Q3. Agni-V is a — (a) cruise missile (b) **ballistic missile** (c) anti-tank missile (d) air-to-air missile

Q4. BrahMos is a joint venture of India and — (a) USA (b) France (c) **Russia** (d) Israel

Q5. Malabar naval exercise involves India, USA, Japan and — (a) UK (b) **Australia** (c) France (d) Russia

Q6. HQ of NATO — (a) Geneva (b) **Brussels** (c) Paris (d) The Hague

Q7. Permanent members of the UN Security Council number — (a) 3 (b) **5** (c) 10 (d) 15

Q8. The 38th Parallel divides — (a) India–China (b) **North–South Korea** (c) USA–Canada (d) France–Germany

Q9. First CDS of India — (a) M.M. Naravane (b) **Bipin Rawat** (c) Anil Chauhan (d) V.K. Singh

Q10. QUAD comprises India, USA, Japan and — (a) UK (b) **Australia** (c) France (d) Russia

Q11. BrahMos is which type of missile — (a) ballistic (b) **cruise** (c) anti-tank (d) surface-to-air

Q12. IMA (Indian Military Academy) is located at — (a) Pune (b) **Dehradun** (c) Chennai (d) Ezhimala

Q13. The Durand Line is the boundary between — (a) India–Pakistan (b) **Afghanistan–Pakistan** (c) India–China (d) India–Nepal

Q14. UN Day is observed on — (a) 10 Dec (b) **24 Oct** (c) 26 Jun (d) 1 Jan

Q15. The father of India's missile programme — (a) Homi Bhabha (b) **A.P.J. Abdul Kalam** (c) Vikram Sarabhai (d) Satish Dhawan

10. Freshly-Created Practice Questions

New questions in the SSC pattern; answer key at the end.

N1. The two Field Marshals of India are Sam Manekshaw and —

(a) K.M. Cariappa (b) Bipin Rawat (c) V.K. Singh (d) K. Sundarji

N2. The Yudh Abhyas military exercise is conducted between India and —

(a) Russia (b) USA (c) France (d) China

N3. Akash is a __ missile.

(a) surface-to-air (b) anti-tank (c) ballistic (d) cruise

N4. The National Defence Academy (NDA) is located at —

(a) Dehradun (b) Khadakwasla (Pune) (c) Chennai (d) Dundigal

N5. The QUAD grouping is primarily focused on —

(a) trade only (b) Indo-Pacific strategic cooperation (c) climate (d) space

N6. The ICJ (International Court of Justice) is headquartered at —

(a) Geneva (b) The Hague (c) New York (d) Vienna

N7. INS Vikrant is India's indigenous —

(a) submarine (b) aircraft carrier (c) destroyer (d) frigate

N8. The Varuna naval exercise is held between India and —

(a) Russia (b) France (c) USA (d) Japan

N9. The G4 nations seeking permanent UNSC membership are India, Japan, Germany and —

(a) Brazil (b) South Africa (c) Australia (d) Canada

N10. The Nag missile is a __ missile.

(a) surface-to-air (b) anti-tank (c) air-to-air (d) cruise

Answer Key (Section 10):

N1-(a) K.M. Cariappa · N2-(b) USA · N3-(a) surface-to-air · N4-(b) Khadakwasla · N5-(b) Indo-Pacific cooperation · N6-(b) The Hague · N7-(b) aircraft carrier · N8-(b) France · N9-(a) Brazil · N10-(b) anti-tank

11. Rapid Revision Sheet

- Supreme Commander → President · Highest Army rank → Field Marshal (Manekshaw, Cariappa) · First CDS → Bipin Rawat
- Academies: NDA (Pune) · IMA (Dehradun) · OTA (Chennai) · Naval (Ezhimala) · Air Force (Dundigal)
- Missiles: Agni (ballistic) · Prithvi (short-range SSM) · Akash (SAM) · Nag (anti-tank) · BrahMos (cruise, Indo-Russia) · Astra (air-to-air)
- Exercises: Malabar (Ind-US-Jpn-Aus naval) · Yudh Abhyas (Ind-US) · Indra (Ind-Rus) · Varuna/Garuda (Ind-Fra) · Hand-in-Hand (Ind-China) · Surya Kiran (Ind-Nepal)

- UN: founded 24 Oct 1945, HQ New York, 193 members · UNSC 5 permanent (US/UK/Fr/Rus/China) + 10 · ICJ → The Hague
- Groupings: BRICS · QUAD (Ind-US-Jpn-Aus) · SCO · G20 · G7 · SAARC · ASEAN · I2U2 · G4 (UNSC bid)
- Lines: Radcliffe (Ind-Pak) · McMahon (Ind-China) · Durand (Afg-Pak) · 38th (Koreas) · 49th (US-Canada) · Maginot (Fr-Ger)
- HQ: NATO Brussels · WHO/WTO Geneva · IMF/World Bank Washington · UNESCO Paris · IAEA/OPEC Vienna

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> ⚠ Verify current summits/appointments before exam. Back to Static GK Index · PYQ Blueprint.